Yasunao Tone's stuttering CDs and extreme digital audio

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Abstract

Yasunao Tone is a composer who has been a much neglected part of the Fluxus movement. At the centre of the moment in Tokyo he was part of a group called Group Ongaku in the 1960s as well as Team Random, the first computer art group in Japan. In June 1972 he moved to American where he currently resides. Since moving to America he has worked with the Merce Cunningham Dance Company and had solo concerts in venues such as The Kitchen, Experimental Intermedia, Roulette, P.S. 1, and The Knitting Factory. In 2000 he received an honorary mention in the Prix Ars Electronica for the work *Wounded Man'yo 2/2000*.

Tone has come to be known for his work with *wounded* CDs which he has used in composition since 1985 when he added scotch taped to a Debussy disc and set it off skipping and jumping through the piece. For *Wounded Man'yo 2/2000* he used a previously computer generated composition burnt to CD-R and then *wounded* to produce a live remix via the CD-player. This method of composition has its history in Tone's early use of indeterminacy and his event works for Fluxus related projects. The paper will explore this history and contextualise his contemporary practice in terms of 'digital audio.'